



Advanced Linear Algebra: Foundations to Frontiers

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3.2.4 Modified Gram-Schmidt (MGS) ¶

03.2.4 Modified Gram-Schmidt, Part 1

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In the video, we reasoned that the following two algorithms compute the same values, except that the columns of Q overwrite the corresponding columns of A :

```
for  $j = 0, \dots, n - 1$ 
   $a_j^\perp := a_j$ 
  for  $k = 0, \dots, j - 1$ 
     $\rho_{k,j} := q_k^H a_j^\perp$ 
     $a_j^\perp := a_j^\perp - \rho_{k,j} q_k$ 
  end
   $\rho_{j,j} := \|a_j^\perp\|_2$ 
   $q_j := a_j^\perp / \rho_{j,j}$ 
end
```

(a) MGS algorithm that computes Q and R from A .

```
for  $j = 0, \dots, n - 1$ 
  for  $k = 0, \dots, j - 1$ 
     $\rho_{k,j} := a_k^H a_j$ 
     $a_j := a_j - \rho_{k,j} a_k$ 
  end
   $\rho_{j,j} := \|a_j\|_2$ 
   $a_j := a_j / \rho_{j,j}$ 
end
```

(b) MGS algorithm that computes Q and R from A , overwriting A with Q .

Homework 3.2.4.1. Assume that $q_0, \dots, q_{k-1}$ are mutually orthonormal. Let $\rho_{j,k} = q_j^H y$ for $j = 0, \dots, i - 1$. Show that

$$\underbrace{q_i^H y}_{\rho_{i,k}} = q_i^H (y - \rho_{0,k} q_0 - \cdots - \rho_{i-1,k} q_{i-1})$$

for $i = 0, \dots, k-1$.

▼ Solution

$$\begin{aligned} & q_i^H (y - \rho_{0,k} q_0 - \cdots - \rho_{i-1,k} q_{i-1}) \\ &= \text{< distribute >} \\ & q_i^H y - q_i^H \rho_{0,k} q_0 - \cdots - q_i^H \rho_{i-1,k} q_{i-1} \\ &= \text{< } \rho_{0,k} \text{ is a scalar >} \\ & q_i^H y - \rho_{0,k} \underbrace{q_i^H q_0}_0 - \cdots - \underbrace{\rho_{i-1,k} q_i^H q_{i-1}}_0 \end{aligned}$$

03.2.4 Modified Gram-Schmidt, Part 2

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This homework illustrates how, given a vector $y \in \mathbb{C}^m$ and a matrix $Q \in \mathbb{C}^{m \times k}$ the component orthogonal to the column space of Q , given by $(I - QQ^H)y$, can be computed by either of the two algorithms given in [Figure 3.2.4.1](#). The one on the left, $\text{Proj} \perp Q_{\text{CGS}}(Q, y)$ projects y onto the column space perpendicular to Q as did the Gram-Schmidt algorithm with which we started. The one on the left successfully subtracts out the component in the direction of q_i using a vector that has been updated in previous iterations (and hence is already orthogonal to $q_0, \dots, q_{i-1}$). The algorithm on the right is one variant of the Modified Gram-Schmidt (MGS) algorithm.

$[y^\perp, r] = \text{Proj}_{\perp Q_{\text{CGS}}}(Q, y)$ (used by CGS)	$[y^\perp, r] = \text{Proj}_{\perp Q_{\text{MGS}}}(Q, y)$ (used by MGS)
$y^\perp = y$ for $i = 0, \dots, k-1$ $\rho_i := q_i^H y$ $y^\perp := y^\perp - \rho_i q_i$ endfor	$y^\perp = y$ for $i = 0, \dots, k-1$ $\rho_i := q_i^H y^\perp$ $y^\perp := y^\perp - \rho_i q_i$ endfor

Figure 3.2.4.1. Two different ways of computing $y^\perp = (I - QQ^H)y = y - Qr$, where $r = Q^H y$. The computed $y^\perp$ is the component of y orthogonal to $\mathcal{C}(Q)$, where Q has k orthonormal columns. (Notice the y on the left versus the $y^\perp$ on the right in the computation of ρ_i .)

These insights allow us to present CGS and this variant of MGS in FLAME notation, in [Figure 3.2.4.2](#) (left and middle).

$[A, R] := \text{GS}(A)$ (overwrites A with Q)		
$A \rightarrow \left(A_L \mid A_R \right), R \rightarrow \left(\begin{array}{c c} R_{TL} & R_{TR} \\ \hline 0 & R_{BR} \end{array} \right)$ A_L has 0 columns and R_{TL} is 0×0 while $n(A_L) < n(A)$		
$\left(A_L \mid A_R \right) \rightarrow \left(A_0 \mid a_1 \mid A_2 \right), \left(\begin{array}{c c} R_{TL} & R_{TR} \\ \hline 0 & R_{BR} \end{array} \right) \rightarrow \left(\begin{array}{c cc} R_{00} & r_{01} & R_{02} \\ \hline 0 & \rho_{11} & r_{12}^T \\ \hline 0 & 0 & R_{22} \end{array} \right)$		
CGS $r_{01} := A_0^H a_1$ $a_1 := a_1 - A_0 r_{01}$ $\rho_{11} := \ a_1\ _2$ $a_1 := a_1 / \rho_{11}$	MGS $[a_1, r_{01}] = \text{Proj}_{\perp Q_{\text{MGS}}}(A_0, a_1)$ $\rho_{11} := \ a_1\ _2$ $a_1 := a_1 / \rho_{11}$	MGS (alternative) $\rho_{11} := \ a_1\ _2$ $a_1 := a_1 / \rho_{11}$ $r_{12}^T := a_1^H A_2$ $A_2 := A_2 - a_1 r_{12}^T$
$\left(A_L \mid A_R \right) \leftarrow \left(A_0 \mid a_1 \mid A_2 \right), \left(\begin{array}{c c} R_{TL} & R_{TR} \\ \hline 0 & R_{BR} \end{array} \right) \leftarrow \left(\begin{array}{c cc} R_{00} & r_{01} & R_{02} \\ \hline 0 & \rho_{11} & r_{12}^T \\ \hline 0 & 0 & R_{22} \end{array} \right)$		
endwhile		

Figure 3.2.4.2. Left: Classical Gram-Schmidt algorithm. Middle: Modified Gram-Schmidt algorithm. Right: Alternative Modified Gram-Schmidt algorithm. In this last algorithm, every time a new column, q_1 , of Q is computed, each column of A_2 is updated so that its component in the direction of q_1 is subtracted out. This means that at the start and finish of the current iteration, the columns of A_L are mutually orthonormal and the columns of A_R are orthogonal to the columns of A_L .

Next, we massage the MGS algorithm into the alternative MGS algorithmic variant given in [Figure 3.2.4.2](#) (right).

03.2.4 Modified Gram-Schmidt, Part 3

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The video discusses how MGS can be rearranged so that every time a new vector q_k is computed (overwriting a_k), the remaining vectors, $\{a_{k+1}, \dots, a_{n-1}\}$, can be updated by subtracting out the component in the direction of q_k . This is also illustrated through the next sequence of equivalent algorithms.

```
for  $j = 0, \dots, n - 1$ 
   $\rho_{j,j} := \|a_j\|_2$ 
   $a_j := a_j / \rho_{j,j}$ 
  for  $k = j + 1, \dots, n - 1$ 
     $\rho_{j,k} := a_j^H a_k$ 
     $a_k := a_k - \rho_{j,k} a_j$ 
  end
end
```

(c) MGS algorithm that normalizes the j th column to have unit length to compute q_j (overwriting a_j with the result) and then subtracts the component in the direction of q_j off the rest of the columns $(a_{j+1}, \dots, a_{n-1})$.

```
for  $j = 0, \dots, n - 1$ 
   $\rho_{j,j} := \|a_j\|_2$ 
   $a_j := a_j / \rho_{j,j}$ 
  for  $k = j + 1, \dots, n - 1$ 
     $\rho_{j,k} := a_j^H a_k$ 
  end
  for  $k = j + 1, \dots, n - 1$ 
     $a_k := a_k - \rho_{j,k} a_j$ 
  end
end
```

(d) Slight modification of the algorithm in (c) that computes $\rho_{j,k}$ in a separate loop.

for $j = 0, \dots, n-1$

$$\rho_{j,j} := \|a_j\|_2$$

$$a_j := a_j / \rho_{j,j}$$

$$\left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} \rho_{j,j+1} & \cdots & \rho_{j,n-1} \end{array} \right) :=$$

$$a_j^H \left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} a_{j+1} & \cdots & a_{n-1} \end{array} \right)$$

$$\left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} a_{j+1} & \cdots & a_{n-1} \end{array} \right) :=$$

$$\left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} a_{j+1} - \rho_{j,j+1}a_j & \cdots & a_{n-1} - \rho_{j,n-1}a_j \end{array} \right)$$

end

(e) Algorithm in (d) rewritten to expose only the outer loop.

for $j = 0, \dots, n-1$

$$\rho_{j,j} := \|a_j\|_2$$

$$a_j := a_j / \rho_{j,j}$$

$$\left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} \rho_{j,j+1} & \cdots & \rho_{j,n-1} \end{array} \right) :=$$

$$a_j^H \left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} a_{j+1} & \cdots & a_{n-1} \end{array} \right)$$

$$\left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} a_{j+1} & \cdots & a_{n-1} \end{array} \right) :=$$

$$\left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} a_{j+1} & \cdots & a_{n-1} \end{array} \right)$$

$$- a_j \left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} \rho_{j,j+1} & \cdots & \rho_{j,n-1} \end{array} \right)$$

end

(f) Algorithm in (e) rewritten to expose the row-vector-times matrix multiplication

$$a_j^H \left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} a_{j+1} & \cdots & a_{n-1} \end{array} \right) \text{ and rank-1}$$

update

$$\left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} a_{j+1} & \cdots & a_{n-1} \end{array} \right) - a_j \left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} \rho_{j,j+1} & \cdots & \rho_{j,n-1} \end{array} \right).$$

Figure 3.2.4.3. Various equivalent MGS algorithms.

This discussion shows that the updating of future columns by subtracting out the component in the direction of the latest column of Q to be computed can be cast in terms of a rank-1 update. This is also captured, using FLAME notation, in the algorithm in [Figure 3.2.4.2](#), as is further illustrated in [Figure 3.2.4.4](#):

Algorithm: $[A, R] := \text{MGS}(A)$

Partition $A \rightarrow \left(\begin{array}{c|c} A_L & A_R \end{array} \right),$

$R \rightarrow \left(\begin{array}{c|c} R_{TL} & R_{TR} \\ \hline 0 & R_{BR} \end{array} \right)$

where A_L has 0 columns and R_{TL} is 0×0

while $n(A_L) < n(A)$ **do**

Repartition

$\left(\begin{array}{c|c} A_L & A_R \end{array} \right) \rightarrow \left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} A_0 & a_1 & A_2 \end{array} \right),$
 $\left(\begin{array}{c|c} R_{TL} & R_{TR} \\ \hline 0 & R_{BR} \end{array} \right) \rightarrow \left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} R_{00} & r_{01} & R_{02} \\ \hline 0 & \rho_{11} & r_{12}^T \\ \hline 0 & 0 & R_{22} \end{array} \right)$

$\rho_{11} := \|a_1\|_2$

$a_1 := a_1 / \rho_{11}$

$r_{12}^T := a_1^H A_2$

$A_2 := A_2 - a_1 r_{12}^T$

Continue with

$\left(\begin{array}{c|c} A_L & A_R \end{array} \right) \leftarrow \left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} A_0 & a_1 & A_2 \end{array} \right),$
 $\left(\begin{array}{c|c} R_{TL} & R_{TR} \\ \hline 0 & R_{BR} \end{array} \right) \leftarrow \left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} R_{00} & r_{01} & R_{02} \\ \hline 0 & \rho_{11} & r_{12}^T \\ \hline 0 & 0 & R_{22} \end{array} \right)$

endwhile

for $j = 0, \dots, n-1$

$\rho_{j,j} := \|a_j\|_2 \quad (\rho_{11} := \|a_1\|_2)$

$a_j := a_j / \rho_{j,j} \quad (a_1 := a_1 / \rho_{11})$

$$\overbrace{\left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} \rho_{j,j+1} & \cdots & \rho_{j,n-1} \end{array} \right)}^{r_{12}^T} := \underbrace{\overbrace{\left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} a_{j+1} & \cdots & a_{n-1} \end{array} \right)}^{A_2}}_{a_1^H}$$

$$\overbrace{\left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} a_{j+1} & \cdots & a_{n-1} \end{array} \right)}^{A_2} := \overbrace{\left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} a_{j+1} & \cdots & a_{n-1} \end{array} \right)}^{A_2} - \underbrace{a_j}_{a_1} \underbrace{\overbrace{\left(\begin{array}{c|c|c} \rho_{j,j+1} & \cdots & \rho_{j,n-1} \end{array} \right)}^{r_{12}^T}}_{r_{12}^T}$$

end

Figure 3.2.4.4. Alternative Modified Gram-Schmidt algorithm for computing the QR factorization of a matrix A .

03.2.4 MGS Algorithm in FLAME notation

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Ponder This 3.2.4.2. Let A have linearly independent columns and let $A = QR$ be a QR factorization of A . Partition

$$A \rightarrow \left(\begin{array}{c|c} A_L & A_R \end{array} \right), \quad Q \rightarrow \left(\begin{array}{c|c} Q_L & Q_R \end{array} \right), \quad \text{and} \quad R \rightarrow \left(\begin{array}{c|c} R_{TL} & R_{TR} \\ \hline 0 & R_{BR} \end{array} \right),$$

where A_L and Q_L have k columns and R_{TL} is $k \times k$.

As you prove the following insights, relate each to the algorithm in [Figure 3.2.4.4](#). In particular, at the top of the loop of a typical iteration, how have the different parts of A and R been updated?

1. $A_L = Q_L R_{TL}$.

($Q_L R_{TL}$ equals the QR factorization of A_L .)

2. $\mathcal{C}(A_L) = \mathcal{C}(Q_L)$.

(The first k columns of Q form an orthonormal basis for the space spanned by the first k columns of A .)

3. $R_{TR} = Q_L^H A_R$.

4. $(A_R - Q_L R_{TR})^H Q_L = 0$.

(Each column in $A_R - Q_L R_{TR}$ equals the component of the corresponding column of A_R that is orthogonal to $\text{Span}(Q_L)$.)

5. $\mathcal{C}(A_R - Q_L R_{TR}) = \mathcal{C}(Q_R)$.

6. $A_R - Q_L R_{TR} = Q_R R_{BR}$.

(The columns of Q_R form an orthonormal basis for the column space of $A_R - Q_L R_{TR}$.)

► [Solution](#)

Homework 3.2.4.3. Implement the algorithm in [Figure 3.2.4.4](#) as

```
function [ Aout, Rout ] = MGS_QR( A, R )
```

Input is an $m \times n$ matrix A and a $n \times n$ matrix R . Output is the matrix Q , which has overwritten matrix A , and the upper triangular matrix R . (The values below the diagonal can be arbitrary.) You may want to use

[Assignments/Week03/matlab/test_MGS_QR.m](#) to check your implementation.

► [Solution](#)